

DIRECT SPEECH & INDIRECT SPEECH

INDIRECT SPEECH (REPORTED SPEECH)

He said , “I am singing a song” (Direct Speech)

**He said that he was singing a song (indirect
speech)**

Reporting verb can be in the present , past or future tense

Eg: says , said , will say

5 Types

- 1) **Statement**
- 2) **Yes / no Question**
- 3) **W.H Question**
- 4) **Imperative Sentence**
- 5) **Exclamatory Sentence**

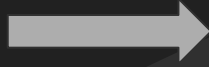
TYPE 1 : STATEMENT

REPORTING VERB : Say (said) , tell (told), etc..

CONNECTING WORD : that

CHANGES OF TENSES IN REPORTED SPEECH

Simple Present



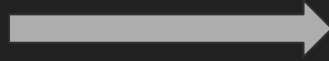
Simple Past

He said , “ I play cricket” = He said that he played cricket

Present Continuous  **Past Continuous**

He said , “ I am playing cricket” = He said that he was playing cricket

Present Perfect

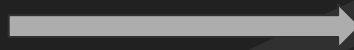


Past Perfect

He said, "I have played cricket."

He said that he had played cricket.

Present Perfect Continuous

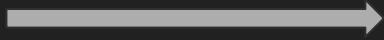


Past Perfect Continuous

He said, "I have been playing cricket."

He said that he had been playing cricket.

Simple Past

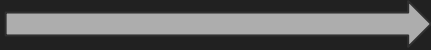


Past Perfect

He said, "I played cricket."

He said that he had played cricket.

Past Continuous



Past Perfect Continuous

He said," I was playing cricket" - He said that he had been playing cricket

Will - would

He said, ' I will play cricket' - He said that he would play cricket

Shall - should / would

He said, ' I shall play cricket' - He said that he would play cricket

can - could

He said, "I can play cricket" ----- He said that he could play cricket

May - might

He said , "It may rain" ----- He said that it might rain

Must - had to

He said, "I must do the work " - -----He said that he had to do the work

Changes of words in reported speech

This ---- that

today -- that day

These ---- those

tonight ---- that night said to - told

Here ----- there

tomorrow --- the next day / the following day

Thus ---- so

day after tomorrow ---- two days later

Now----- then

next week/month / year ----- the following week / month / year

ago -----before

yesterday ---- the previous day

Come ---go (not always)

day before yesterday ---- two days before

Last night / week / month / year -----the previous night / week / month / year

He said , “I Will play cricket tomorrow”

He said that he would play cricket the following day

Sam said, "I like ice-cream"

Sam said that he liked ice-cream

Veena said to me, “ I am ill”

Veena told me that she was ill

He said to me , “ You should come to my party”

He told me that I should go to his party

Meenu said , “ I am writing a letter”

Meenu said that she was writing a letter

I said, “I can finish my homework”

I said that I could finish my homework

My uncle said to me, “You will become a doctor”

My uncle told me that I would become a doctor”

Raju said , “I ate an apple”

Raju said that he had eaten an apple

Maya said , “ I was reading a novel”

Maya said that she had been reading a novel

Ram said to me , “ You may pass the exam”

Ram told me that I might pass the exam

If the reporting verb is in THE PRESENT TENSE or in THE FUTURE TENSE, there should not be any changes made in the tense of the subordinate clause.

My uncle says, “ I like old melodies”

My uncle says that he likes old melodies

The farmer will say, “I am busy”

The farmer will say that he is busy

When a NATURAL TRUTH, PROVERB, QUOTATION etc.. are reported , there is no need to change their tenses.

The teacher said , The sun rises in the east”

The teacher said that the sun rises in the east

John keats wrote, “ A thing of beauty is a joy forever”

John keats wrote that a thing of beauty is a joy forever

2) YES / NO Questions in Reported Speech

Reporting Verb : Ask , want to know , enquire, etc..

Connecting word : if / whether

Eg : He said to me , “Has she gone ? ”

He asked me whether she had gone.

(if/whether + subject + verb)

‘Do you know the way to the station ?’She said to Mahim

She asked Mahim if he knew the way to the station

“Did you hear the news ?” he said to her.

“ Are you weeping ?” he asked her

He asked her whether she was weeping

“Does she require any help?” the old man asked me.

The old man asked me if she required any help

Madhu asked me , “ Do you like ice-cream”

Madhu asked me whether I liked ice-cream

The girl asked her father , “Have you bought a toy for me?”

The girl asked her father whether he had bought a toy for her

WH Questions in indirect speech

REPORTING VERB : Ask , want to know , enquire, etc..

Connecting word : Nil (Same Question words are used)

Eg: He asked me, " Where are you going?"

He asked me where I was going

(Question word + subject + verb)

He asked me where was I going (X)

Shyam asked me, “Where is your house”

Shyam asked me where my house was

He said to me , “What are you doing ?”

He asked me what I was doing

I said to the man, “Who are you”

I asked the man who he was

“Where do you live ?” asked the stranger

The stranger asked me where I lived

He said to me , “Which book do you want?”

He asked me which book I wanted

“How did you do that” they asked Edison.

They asked Edison how he had done that

Imperative Sentences in Reported Speech

Reporting verb : tell , order , command , request , advise , suggest , beg , encourage , recommend , instruct , warn, forbid, etc

Connecting word : to

Eg: "Sit down Sita," he said

He told Sita to sit down

He said to me “Open the door”

He told me to open the door

“ Don’t jump into the water,” She said to the children

She told the children **not to** jump into the the water

“Please do not punish the boy” I said to the teacher

I requested the teacher not to punish the boy

He said to me , “Please wait here till I return”

He requested me to wait there till he returned

“Sit down” she said

She told me/him/her/us/them to sit down

Exclamatory Sentences in Reported Speech

Reporting verb : **exclaim , wonder , cryout, swear, shout, applaud, exclaim in grief, exclaim in joy, exclaim in wonder**

Connecting word : **that**

He said , “What a delightful performance !”

He exclaimed that it was a very delightful performance

The boy said , “ What a fool I am !”

The boy exclaimed that he was a great fool

He said , “ What a nice bird it is !”

He exclaimed that it was a very nice bird

When sentences with interjections(hurrah , bravo, ouch etc..) are reported, suitable words that shows these emotions, are used.

Eg: The boy said , Hurrah ! “we have won the match”

The boy exclaimed in joy that they had won the match

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Eg: The boy said , Hurrah ! “we have won the match”

The boy exclaimed in joy that they had won the match

He said to me , “ Alas ! I could not save you”

He exclaimed in grief that he could not save me

MCQS

Beggar said to Ramu , “Give some water”

- a) Beggar requested ramu to give him some water
- b) Beggar asked Ramu some water
- c) Beggar wanted Ramu to give water
- d) Beggar ordered Ramu to give water

“ Why are you late” he asked me

- a) He asked me why I was late
- b) He asked me if I was late
- c) He asked me why I am late
- d) He asked me why we was late

“ Don’t sleep late and miss the bus,” said Mr. Varma

- a) Mr.Varma advised us not to sleep late and miss the bus**
- b) Mr.Varma advised us don’t sleep late and miss the bus**
- c) Mr.Varma advised us to sleep late and miss the bus**
- d) Mr.Varma advised us not to sleep late and missed the bus**

He said , “Please let me go”

- a) He requested them to let him go
- b) He request them to let him go
- c) He requested them to let him went
- d) He requested them let him go

Teacher asked Smitha what

- a) Was she doing
- b) She was doing
- c) She is doing
- d) Is she doing

Father advised Raju use soft drinks

- a) not to b) do not c) not d) should not

Teacher asked us why In the class

- a) We are talking
- b) We were talking
- c) We have talked
- d) Were we talking

The stranger asked Sara where she

- a) live
- b) Lived
- c) Has lived
- d) Have lived

Devanarayanan asked the boy :

- a) What was he doing
- b) What he was doing
- c) What he does
- d) What he would done

Patient to the doctor, “ Can I take solid food?”

- a) The patient asked the doctor whether she could take solid food
- b) The patient asked the doctor whether she can take solid food
- c) The patient asked the doctor whether she could took solid food
- d) The patient asked the doctor whether she will take solid food

He said, “I bought a house in Mumbai”. The indirect speech of this sentence is:

- a) He said that he bought a house in Mumbai.
- b) He said that he was bought a house in Mumbai.
- c) He said that he had bought a house in Mumbai.
- d) He said that he has bought a house in Mumbai.

“I don't like tea”, he said.

- a) He said that he do not like tea.
- b) He said that he did not like tea.
- c) He said that he doesn't like tea.
- d) He said that he hadn't like tea.

The reported speech of, **He said, "I have done my homework"** is:

- a) He said that he has done his homework.
- b) He said that he was done his homework.
- c) He said that he has been done his homework.
- d) He said that he had done his homework,

“I came here yesterday to get the work started”, said Naveen.

- a) Naveen said that he has come there the day before to get the work started
- b) Naveen said that he had come there the day before to get the work started .
- c) Naveen said that he came there the day before to get the work had started
- d) Naveen said that he had came there the day before to get the work started

Raju says, "I am a farmer".

- a) Raju said that he was a farmer
- b) Raju says that he is a farmer
- c) Raju said that he is a farmer
- d) Raju says that he was a farmer

Report: "Why are you late"? He asked me:

- a) He asked me if I was late
- b) He asked me why I was late
- c) He He asked me if I was late
- d) He asked me why are you late

Mary said, "I am watching television".

- a) Mary said that she is watching television
- b) Mary said that she has been watching television
- c) Mary said that she watches television
- d) Mary said that she was watching television

“You may leave the room.” Said the principal. Change into indirect speech.

- a) The principal said that I might leave the room .
- b) The principal said that I may leave the room
- c) The principal says that I might leave the room
- d) The principal said that I could leave the room

Arun said, “charity begins at home”.

- a) Arun said that charity begins at home .
- b) Arun stated that charity began at home
- c) Arun was sure that charity begins at home
- d) Arun doubted if charity began at home

“Don’t sleep late and miss the bus” , said Mr. Varma.

- a) Mr. Varma advised us not to sleep late and miss the bus.
- b) Mr. Varma advises us don’t to sleep late and miss the bus
- c) Mr. Varma advised us to sleep late and miss the bus
- d) Mr. Varma advised us not to sleep late and missed the bus

The lady said, "I saw the culprit."

- a) The lady said that she had saw the culprit
- b) The lady said that she had seen the culprit.
- c) The lady said that she saw the culprit
- d) None of these.

She said to him, "Why don't you go today?"

- a) She asked him why he didn't go that day.
- b) She asked him why he had not gone that day.
- c) She asked him why he do not go that day
- d) She asked him why he did not go today

Teacher said to Jack, “Don’t be late again tomorrow”.

- a) Teacher warned Jack not to be late again the next day.
- b) Teacher warned Jack not to be late again tomorrow
- c) Teacher says Jack not to be late again the next day
- d) None of these

Tom asked the stranger, “where did you go?”

- a) Tom asked the stranger where he went,
- b) Tom asked the stranger where he had gone,
- c) Tom asked the stranger where do you go
- d) Tom asked the stranger where had he gone

The patient to the doctor, “can I take solid food?”

- a) The patient asked the doctor whether she can take solid food
- b) The patient asked the doctor whether she could take solid food
- c) The patient asked the doctor whether could she take solid food
- d) The patient asks the doctor whether she could take solid food

Report the following sentence:

“Has your wife gone to the school”? I asked him.

- a) I asked him whether his wife had gone to the school.
- b) I asked him if his wife has gone to the school
- c) I asked him that whether had his wife gone to the school
- d) I asked him has his wife gone to the school

Kamala said, "I am late".

- a) Kamala said that she is late
- b) Kamala said that she will late
- c) Kamala said that she was late
- d) Kamala says that she was late

Teacher asked us whyin the class.

- a) are we talking
- b) We were talking
- c) We have talked
- d) Were we talking

She said, "Are you ready"?

- a) She said that whether I am ready
- b) She asked that whether I was ready
- c) She asked whether I was ready
- d) She asked whether I am ready

“Don’t make noise”, the teacher asked the students.

- a) The teacher asked the students don’t make noise
- b) The teacher asked the students to make noise
- c) The teacher asked the students not to make noise
- d) The teacher asked the students to make not noise

Devanarayanan asked the boy

- a) What was he doing?
- b) What he was doing.
- c) What he does
- d) What he will do?

She said, "I wish to learn English."

- a) She said that I wished to learn English
- b) She said that she wished to learn English.
- c) She said that she wishes to learn English
- d) She said that she is wishing to learn English

Change into indirect speech: **He said to me, “you alone can save her”.**

- a) He said that I alone can save her
- b) He said that you alone can save her.
- c) He told me that I alone could save her.
- d) He told me that I alone can save her

The lady to the thief, “please, don’t kill me”.

- a) The lady requested the thief don’t kill her.
- b) The lady requested the thief not to kill her.
- c) The lady requested the thief didn’t kill her
- d) The lady requested the thief not to killed her

Change into reported speech:

The boy said, "I like sweets."

- a) The boy says that he liked sweets.
- b) The boy said that he had liked sweets.
- c) The boy said that he liked sweets.
- d) The boy says that he has liked sweets.

“Are the windows open?”, he said.

- a) He said whether the windows are open
- b) He asked that the windows were open
- c) He asked whether the windows were open
- d) He asked whether the windows are open

The reported speech of **Mary said, "I am watching television"** is:

- a) Mary said that she is watching Television.
- b) Mary said that she had been watching Television
- c) Mary said that she watches Television
- d) Mary said that she was watching Television.

I said, “did she write the exam?”

- a) I asked if she wrote the exam
- b) I asked if she had written the exam
- c) I asked if she has written the exam
- d) I asked if she would write the exam

Meenu said, "my mother sang well."

- a) Meenu said that her mother sang well
- b) Meenu said that her mother had sung well
- c) Meenu said that her mother has sang well
- d) Meenu said that her mother have sung well

The indirect form of “Do you like comics?” She asked me, is:

- a) She asked me whether I like comics
- b) She asked me whether I have liked comics
- c) She asked me whether I liked comics.
- d) She asked me did like comics

Mary asked John whether he Hamlet.

- a) Had read
- b) Has read
- c) Has been read
- d) Reads

Kannan said, "I wrote a letter." Report the sentence:

- a) Kannan said that he had written a letter.
- b) kannan said that he has written a letter
- c) Kannan said that he had been writing a letter
- d) Kannan said that he wrote a letter

“Bring me a glass of milk”, said Swami to the villagers.

- a) Swami told to the villagers to bring a glass of milk
- b) Swami told the villagers to bring me a glass of milk
- c) Swami told villagers to bring a glass of milk
- d) Swami told the villagers to bring him a glass of milk

Report: "Is your book on Shakespeare", he asked her.

- a) He asked her if your book is on Shakespeare
- b) He asked her if her book was on Shakespeare.
- c) He asked her if her book were on Shakespeare
- d) He told her if her book is on Shakespeare

I said to Hari, “why are you lazy?”

- a) I asked Hari that why he was lazy
- b) I asked Hari why was he lazy
- c) I asked Hari why he was lazy
- d) I asked Hari why were lazy

Arun said, "Charity begins at home." Report the sentence:

- a) Arun said that charity began at home
- b) Arun stated that charity begins at home.
- c) Arun was sure that charity began at home
- d) Arun doubted that charity began at home

“I am going out”, he said.

- a) He said that I am going out
- b) He said that I was going out
- c) He said that he is going out
- d) He said that he was going out

He said, "I shall come."

- a) He said that he shall come
- b) He said that he might come
- c) He said that he would come.
- d) He said that he could come

Change into indirect speech:

She exclaimed, "What a beautiful child"

- a) She exclaimed that the child is beautiful.
- b) She exclaimed that it is a very beautiful child.
- c) She exclaimed that the child was beautiful.
- d) She exclaimed that it was a very beautiful child.

The teacher said to the students, “When did you get up yesterday”

- a) The teacher asked the students when did they get up the previous day
- b) The teacher asked the students when they get up the previous day
- c) The teacher asked the students when they had got up the previous day.
- d) The teacher asked the students when they had been got up the previous day

Complete the following indirect speech:

“Have you understood my instructions?” He said to me.

He asked me

- a) If I had understood his instructions.
- b) If I have understood his instructions
- c) If I have been understood his instructions
- d) If you understood my instructions

Change into indirect speech: "Oh dear ! I've lost my purse", she said:

- a) She said that she lost her purse
- b) She exclaimed that she had lost her purse
- c) She said that she had lost her purse
- d) She expressed that she had lost her purse

51. The policeman asked me where

- a) I am going
- b) I was going.
- c) Am I going
- d) Was I going

THANK YOU

Optative Sentences(wishes,prayers)

Reporting Verb: wish , pray ,desire, long for etc...

Connecting word : that

I said to him, “ May you be happy”

I wished that he might be happy

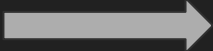
Father said to me, “ May God bless you”

Father prayed that God might bless me

He said , “ May his soul rest in peace

He prayed that his soul might rest in peace

Imperative sentences beginning with 'let'

proposal/suggestion  reporting verb = propose / suggest

Connecting word : that

Manu said to his friends, "Let us have a picnic"

Manu proposed (suggested) to his friends that they should have a picnic

If let doesn't show a **proposal or suggestion** , **might** or **'might be allowed to'** - is used instead of **'let'**

Eg: **We said, 'Let him tell the story'**

We said that he might (might be allowed to) tell the story

Conditional Clause in reported speech

Conditional clause 2&3 are reported , no need to change their tenses

Eg; She said, If he were younger I would marry him

She said that if he were younger she would marry him

John said , “If I had known earlier, I would not have come here”

John said that if he had known earlier he would not have gone there

Thank You